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Tax break for United Center plan gets OK

Chicago aldermen advance \$55 million abatement for redevelopment of parking lots around stadium

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicago aldermen advanced a \$54.7 million tax break Monday for the \$7 billion plan by owners of the Bulls and Blackhawks to redevelop parking lots around the United Center into thousands of residences, plus businesses and a concert hall.

The Reinsdorf and Wirtz fami-

lies now argue they need the 12-year property tax cut moving ahead in the City Council to jump-start one of the largest developments in the city's history, a sprawling bid to remake the Near West Side neighborhood. And their representatives on Monday did not rule out coming back to the city to ask for additional reductions as the work advances. They initially touted the plan's private funding.

The abatement is necessary in order to lock down the remaining 80% of private financing needed to move the plan forward, United Center CFO Steve Rucks told aldermen.

"With the market where it is today and construction costs where they are, it's been a struggle to get that remainder," Rucks said. "A lot of that remaining 80% is contingent upon the resolution of this (abatement)."

Members of the council Economic Committee unanimously advanced the abatement in a voice

vote. It is expected to face a final vote by the full council next week.

The tax break is tied to the \$500 million initial phase of the seven-phase project. That start is set to include a 6,000-seat music hall, a boutique hotel, several parking garages with ground-level retail space and nearly 10 acres of green spaces.

Known as the 1901 Project, the development is set to be finished in an about 15 years, when it is expected to add nearly 10,000 new homes, 20% reserved as affordable, to the area now defined by

unsightly parking lots surrounding the stadium. Even with the abatement, the initial project will result in an estimated net increase of \$46.3 million in tax revenue, according to the city's Department of Planning and Development.

The City Council approved needed zoning changes for the plan in February, clearing the way for construction to begin. But Johnson's administration announced in March that it was supporting a tax break sought by the

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Trump: Ceasefire on 'life support'

Diplomacy with Iran stalls with plan rejected as 'piece of garbage'

By Jon Gambrell, Samy Magdy and Seung Min Kim
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — President Donald Trump on Monday said the Iran ceasefire is on "life support" after rejecting Tehran's latest proposal, which officials said included some nuclear concessions. Trump also proposed suspending the federal gas tax to help with higher fuel prices caused by the war.

The stalled diplomacy and recent exchanges of fire could tip the Middle East back into open warfare and prolong the worldwide energy crisis sparked by the conflict.

Iran still has a chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz, a vital waterway for global oil and gas shipments, and America is blockading Iranian ports.

Asked at the White House if the ceasefire was still in effect, Trump said it's on "life support."

"I would call it the weakest right now after reading that piece of garbage they sent us," Trump added. "I didn't even finish reading it."

Trump also said he supported a suspension of the federal tax on gasoline — just over 18 cents per gallon and 24 cents for diesel. Congress, which is controlled by Republicans, would have to approve. The tax brings in more than \$23 billion each year.

His pledge came after fuel prices surged past \$4.50 a gallon last week. Trump predicted that the price of oil and gas would drop "like a rock" as soon as hostilities are over.

Trump has demanded a major rollback of Iran's nuclear activities, while Iran is pushing for a more

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'It was terrifying'

By Rebecca Johnson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The woman parked her car and thought about going to the front entrance of her luxury River North apartment building. But walking through the front door felt impossible.

So the woman instead hurried from the parking lot through the building's back entrance, bypassing the front desk where she worried that the security guard who allegedly sexually assaulted her would be sitting.

Once back at her apartment, she still wasn't safe from her thoughts. She worried someone could break into her unit.

"I was just in a state of fear and panic," she told the Tribune. "It was terrifying."

That's why the woman said it was so

Chicago woman sues luxury residential managers for not allowing her to break lease after alleged assault by guard

Above: A woman stands in a Cook County forest preserve on Wednesday, where she likes to walk to calm her mind. She said she was sexually assaulted in 2024 in her apartment at Niche 905 by a building's security guard.

STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

"devastating" when she wasn't permitted to break her lease at Niche 905 in late 2024. For two months, when she couldn't stay with her mom or friends, she had to sleep in the apartment — and in the bed — where the alleged rape took place, she said.

In January 2025, the woman sued Willow Bridge Property Co., the property manager, and Titan Security Group, the company Willow Bridge contracted to provide security services. The suit accused the companies of "systemic failures" that led to the assault as well as inflicting "emotional distress" by refusing to allow her to break her lease.

Now, as the case slowly makes its way through Cook County Court, the woman said she's ready to speak out for the first time to spread awareness of the challenges faced

See **LAWSUIT** on Page A4

After encampment was cleared, what's next?

Residents, activists focus on broader issues after Legion Park closure

By Madeline King
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Leonilo Laude lives in one of the dozen or so tents just west of the Chicago River in Ronan Park on the North Side. He's been homeless since a fire destroyed his apartment two years ago.

Laude, 39, moved to Ronan Park after the city closed another encampment in Legion Park in March. During the encampment cleanout, city officials disposed of all his tools, which allowed him to work as a mechanic, he said.

Now, Laude is working with a

caseworker, waiting to get the keys to a place of his own. Laude said his mom, Carmen — who was homeless alongside him while battling breast cancer — has already moved into an apartment. She's one of 12 former Legion Park residents the Chicago Department of Family and Support Services said have been successfully housed so far as of May 7.

Laude said DFSS offered him a spot in a shelter after the Legion Park encampment was shuttered, but his mom was still living outside then, and he didn't want to leave her or his community until he knew they'd all be sorted with housing. As that day approaches, Laude said he's looking forward to accepting

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Leonilo Laude stands beside his tent in Ronan Park in Chicago's Albany Park neighborhood on Friday. **CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE**

China, US prepare for trade showdown

President Donald Trump and China's leader, Xi Jinping, meet in Beijing this week, with both governments bracing for a long economic war, mapping vulnerabilities and sharpening tools to inflict pain on the other.

Nation & World

Who might Bulls pick in NBA draft?

After moving up in the NBA draft with a little luck, now comes the hard part for the Bulls: deciding which players to watch at Nos. 4 and 15. The best of the class is now congregated in the South Loop for the NBA draft combine. **Chicago Sports**

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